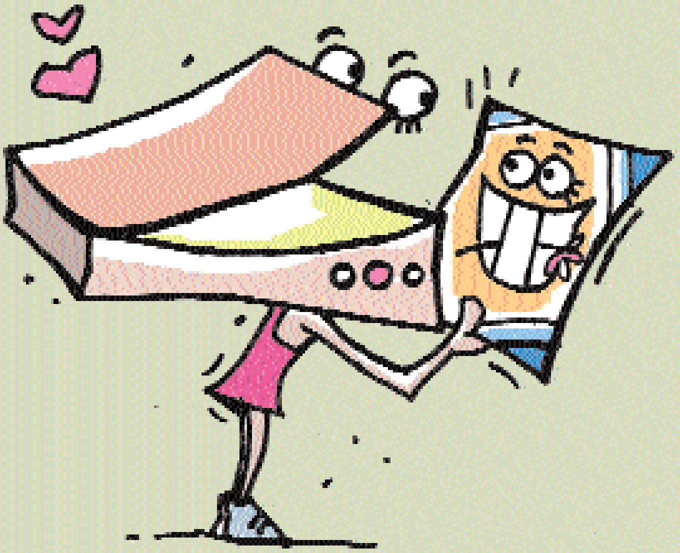
SCANNING

A scan lets you get that lovely little picture onto your desktop. Using these nifty tricks while you are at it!

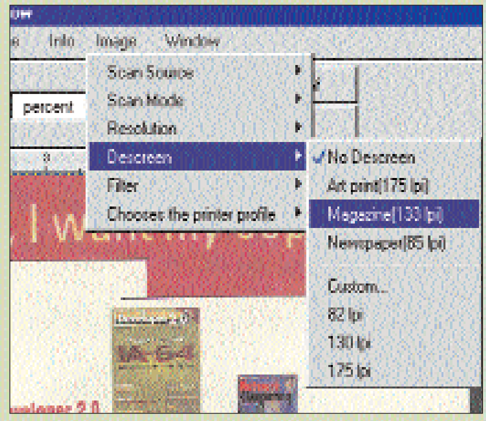


Buying a scanner

Before buying a scanner, you need to keep your budget in mind and evaluate the scanner on the following points: Resolution, measured in dots per inch (dpi), determines the sharpness of the scan. Typical flatbed scanners offer a resolution ranging from 600 to 2400 dpi. The second factor is Dynamic Range. Scanners that reproduce white perfectly have a minimal optical density or Dmin of 0.0. On the other hand, scanners that output a perfect black have a maximum optical density or Dmax of 4.0. These two values constitute the dynamic range of the scanner. Typical values for these are 2.5 and 3.5.

Another factor is the Bit Depth. This is concerned with the analog to digital conversion of images, during scanning. Typically, scanners have 48-bit conversions, with 16-bit each for red, blue and green. The next feature that you should consider is the speed of scanning. Though there is no standard method of measuring the speed, you can compare the time taken to scan the same image at the same settings by different scanners.

Finally, look for transparency adapters for scanning slides and negatives, Automated Document Feeders (ADF), etc. If you are looking for any of these features, make sure that you buy a model which come with these accessories, as buying them separately is expensive.



Use Descreen filter when scanning printed material

Calibrating the scanner

Calibrate your scanner every one or two months for optimum results. Calibration involves scanning a known colour and adjusting the output to match that colour. In case the scanner doesn't support calibration, get a standard gray (RGB=128, 128, 128) reference colour card from a photo lab, and scan the image along with it. Open it in Photoshop and press [I] to activate the Eyedropper tool. The Info Palette shows the RGB values as you move the mouse pointer over the colour card. If it matches with the actual colour (RGB = 128, 128, 128 in this case), your image colours are perfect. Otherwise, change the colour balance and brightness of the

Calculating image size and PPI

Use this table to calculate the scan dpi, depending on the print resolution and printed size desired:

Printer Type	Standard inkjet printer	High-quality inkjet printer	Photo-quality inkjet printer
Print Resolution	300 to 320 dpi	600 to 720 dpi	1,200 to 2,880 dpi
Scan Resoltion	150 ppi	150 to 240 ppi	240 to 360 ppi
Printed Size	**Actual Pixel Dimensions (Average)**		
2 x 3-inch	300 x 450 pixels	400 x 600 pixels	600 x 900 pixels
4 x 6-inch	600 x 900 pixels	800 x 1,200 pixels	1,200 x 1,800 pixels
5 x 7-inch	750 x 1,050 pixels	1,000 x 1,400 pixels	1,500 x 2,100 pixels
8 x 10-inch	1,200 x 1,500 pixels	1,600 x 2,000 pixels	2,400 x 3,000 pixels